



First year / First semester

2024/2025

Prepared by
Medical-Surgical Nursing Staff

Table of Contents

NO.	UNIT TITLE:	PAGE
1.	Introduction to Nursing Ethics	3
2.	Principles of Ethics.	12
3.	Values in Nursing Profession.	22
4.	Code of Ethics.	32
8.	Rights & Responsibilities of Clients & Nurses.	39
9.	Ethics and Professional Conduct to Nursing Students.	51
11	References	60

Chapter (1)



Introduction to Nursing Ethics And Related Definitions

Introduction to Nursing Ethics

And Related Definitions

Learning Objectives:

On completion of this lecture the nursing student should be able to:

- Identify the historical background of professional nursing ethics.
- Define the professional ethics and related terms.
- Identify types of Ethics.
- Discuss the importance of ethics in nursing.
- Explain the three categories of human rights.

Content Outlines:

- Historical background related of professional nursing ethics.
- The professional ethics and related terms.
- Types of Ethics.
- The importance of ethics in nursing.
- The three categories of human rights.

Introduction:

- Historically, the beginning of **professional nursing** can be traced to the 19th -century, when the England School of Nursing was established founded by **Florence Nightingale**, where profession-shaping ethical rules and values were communicated.
- **Florence Nightingale** was born of rich parents in the Italian city, where she received an advanced education. At the young age of 16, Florence believed that she heard God's voice urging her to do something special to help others. As she grew older, she began to take an interest in how sick people were cared for and how they regained their health. In her twenties, Florence decided that she would become a nurse and fulfill her intense desire to help the sick. Her parents were greatly surprised and upset that Florence wished to be a nurse. In the time of Florence's life, nursing was not considered an important or prestigious profession and one that was usually performed by poor men and women.
- **Nightingale's achievement** was a landmark in nursing even though, performance of graduates was below the desired expectations in the early days. The prospective nurses were **trained by male physicians** because of the inadequate nursing teachers in the first **30 to 40 years Nightingale's school**.
- The focus on nurse's obedience to physicians remained at the forefront of nursing responsibilities into the 1960s. Over the years most nurses have been women and most doctors have been men.
- Nurses & other health professional need to have ethical, moral & legal cultural knowledge to guide their care decision and action in a justifiable & defensible ways.



Definitions of Related Terms:

Nursing:

- **Nursing** is the provision of care to enable people to maintain, or recover health, as well as cope with health problems to achieve the best quality of life, either in disability until death.



- Advocacy, promotion of a safe environment, research, participation in shaping health policy is also key nursing roles.

Ethics:

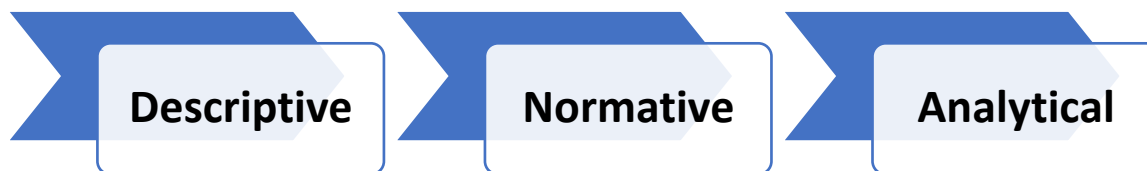
- The term of ethics is derived from the Greek word “**ethos**”, which means customs, habitual usage, conduct and character.
- **Ethics** are rules or standards that govern the conduct of the person or the conduct of the members of a profession
- **Ethics** help to differentiate the right from the wrong conduct or indicate how things should be.

Bioethics

- It is the science that concerned with problems associated in the field of medicine, or nursing (e.g. Abortion, Euthanasia).



Types of Ethics:



- **Descriptive:**

It is the description of the values and beliefs of various cultural, religious or social groups about health and illness.

- **Normative:**

It is a study of human activities in a broad sense in an attempt to identify human actions that are right or wrong, good and bad qualities (What we ought to do).

- **Analytical:**

It analyzes the meaning of moral terms. It seeks the reasons why these action or attitudes are either wrong or right.

Nursing Ethics: Refers to ethical issues involved in nursing practice.

Importance of Ethics in Nursing:

Ethics provides us with:

- *The rules and principles for decision making and action.*
- *A base for regulating the relationship between nurse, patient, co-workers, society and profession.*
- *Make standards of practice and profession.*
Example: In case of Dilemma, Abortion and Euthanasia (mercy killing)
- *Promotes the sense of fundamental responsibilities of nursing care as to promote health, to restore health, to prevent illness and to alleviate suffering.*
- *Enhances the development of caring attitude, sense of*

responsibility and accountability.

- *Promotes an environment* in which the values, customs and religious beliefs of clients/ patients are respected.



Moral:

- **Moral** is derived from the Latin “**mores**” means **custom/ tradition/ practice** or **habit**.
- **Based on a standard of what is right and what is wrong**, as well as good or bad.
- Learned through socialization.
- Usually based on religious beliefs.

N.B. Morals are similar to ethics and many people use the two words interchangeably (It is closely associated with the concept of ethics).

Moral Distress:

Possible Reasons for Moral Distress:

- It arises when individuals cannot fulfill ethical obligations.
- It happens when individuals fail to accomplish what they believe to be the right course of action and live up to their own expectations.
- It occurs when the nurses are unable to follow their moral beliefs because of institutional or other restriction.

Example

The distress occurs when the nurse violates a personal moral value and fails to fulfill perceived responsibility.

N.B.

It may result in feelings of guilt, concern or distaste.

Values are:

- Concepts or ideas that give meaning to one's life.
- Beliefs or attitudes about the worth of a person, object, idea or action.
- Provide a framework for one's decisions and actions.

Student's examples (Assignment).

Behaviour:

- It is an observable action.
- The manner in which individual behaves.
- The action or reaction of person under given circumstances.

Ethical behavior:

- It is day by day expression of **person's commitment to another**.
- **The beliefs and practices** of a certain group; such as nursing and medical ethics.

- **The expected standard of moral behaviors** of a particular group as described in their code of professional ethics.

Attitude: (Positive or Negative):

- It is a person's temper towards an object /situation, or settled behaviors.
- It can be a mental or emotional.
- It can be positive or negative.
- It is seen in behavior and opinion.

Beliefs:

- They are ideas that individual accepts as being true or real.
- A type of attitude, which is based more on faith than fact.
- They are judged as correct or incorrect.

Virtue:

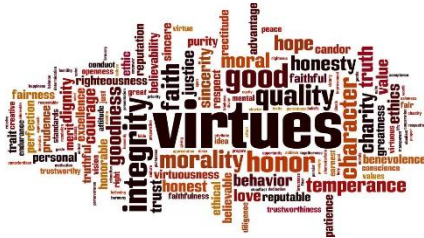
- Moral excellence and righteousness; goodness.
- An example or kind of moral excellence.
- Virtues are cultivated traits of character that motivate a person to do:
 - The right action.
 - At the right time.
 - With the right motivation.
 - For the right reason.

A person using this approach may ask themselves:

N.B.

"If I carry out these actions, what kind of person will I be?"

Examples of virtues:



a)Courage.

b)Honesty.

c)Compassion.

d)Justice.

e)Insight

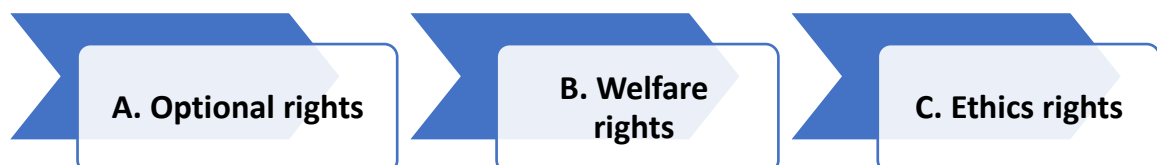
Laws:

- Enforceable rules.
- Necessary for social conduct.
- Designed to prevent the actions of one group from infringing or attacking on the rights of another group.

Rights:

- The power that one deserves according to just claims (asking), legal guarantees, or moral principles.

Rights have Three Categories:



Rights have Three Categories:

A. Optional Rights:

- It is the freedom of choice; that allows one to live one's life as one chooses within a set of prescribed boundaries.

Example: People can wear whatever clothes and colors, as long as they didn't infringe on the rights of others.

B. Welfare Rights:

- It is the legal rights; they are based on legal entitlements to benefits that are granted by law.

Example: It is to freedom of speech, walk, swim, shopping, go to the cinema, etc.

C. Ethical Rights:

- It is the moral right; it is just a claim to something based on a moral principle that may not have the power of law to back up the claim.

Example: In health care, nurse should protect patients' dignity and his privacy.....etc.



Chapter (2)



Principles of Ethics In Nursing

Principles of Ethics in Nursing

Learning Objectives:

After completion of this lecture the students should be able to:

- Define the key terms.
- Identify the eight main ethical principles in nursing.
- Discuss each principle supported with examples.
- Apply ethical and legal principles related to patient education as an example.
- Implement ethical principles with different individuals such as colleagues, supervisors, patients, groups, families and other health care providers.

Content Outlines:

- Definitions of the ethical principles.
- The eight main ethical principles in nursing.
- Examples of each ethical principle in nursing.



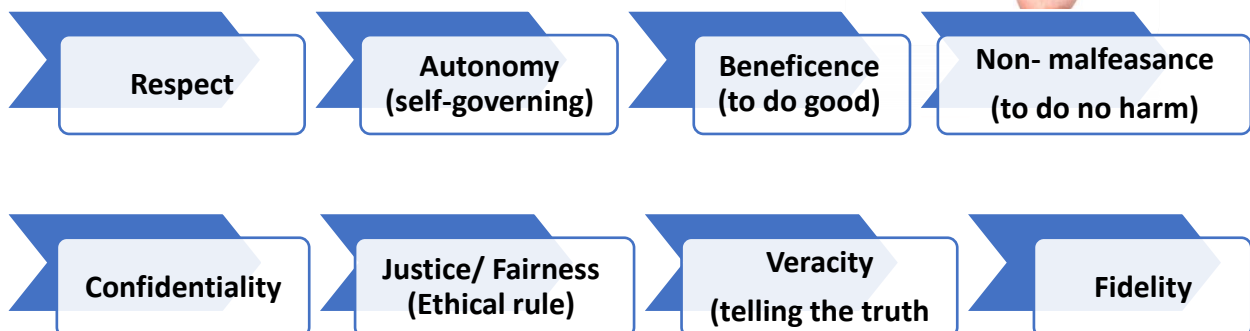
Introduction:

- The ethical and legal responsibilities include ***Eight major principles***, which are addressed throughout the ***American Nurse Association*** (ANA)'s ***Code of Ethics (2001)***. These principles cover the very issues that precipitated federal intervention into healthcare affairs.
- **Ethical principles** provide the foundation for moral values, and nursing practices, which are specific prescriptions for actions e.g. “People should not lie” (rule), it is based on the moral principle of respect and autonomy for people.
 - **Ethical principles** are considered as basis for nurse’s decisions when making clinical judgments.

Definition:

Ethical principles refer to those general judgments that serve as a justification for particular ethical prescriptions and evaluations of human actions.

The Eight Major Nursing Principles are:



1. Respect:

- It's one of the main principles of ethics.
- It means treating people as **unique, equal** and **responsible** moral clients.
- This principle **emphasizes people's importance** as members of the community and health services team.
- It is applied not only in clinical settings, but also in all life's' situations.
- This principle emphasize that all people should treat others as a worthy individual.
- Respect, specifically in nursing practice means consider the client's autonomy.

Example

- Stand up when an older person enters the room.
- When an adult drops something, you should rush to pick it up
- Speak in a soft tone of voice, especially in public places

2. Autonomy (self-governing):

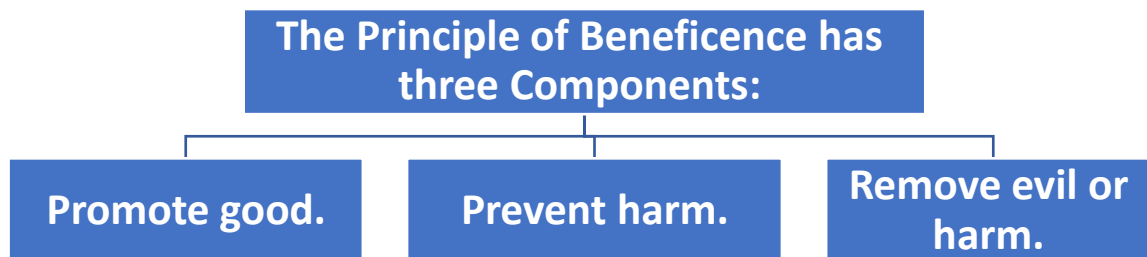
- **The word of autonomy** is derived from the Greek words **Nomo (law)**.
- Autonomy means **freedom of choice**.
- Autonomy is the right of **self-determination/ self-governing**
- Laws have been acted out to protect the patient's right independently.
- Respect of client's rights, values and choices is synonym person's autonomy

- The nurse's should respect patients' rights to make their own decisions, even if the nurse does not agree with the patients' decisions.
- Client's autonomy to make decision and action needs adequate information.
- By the law, either at the hospital admission or prior to care provision client should be informed in writing about the followings:
- The right to refuse medical or surgical care (freedom of choice).
- Individualism and self-determination are dominant values underlying this principle.
- **Documentation** of such instruction must appear in the patient's record, which is the legal document validating that informed consent took place.
- ***Informed Consent*** is an important outcome of this principle: the nurse should instruct client/patient about the followings:



3. Beneficence:

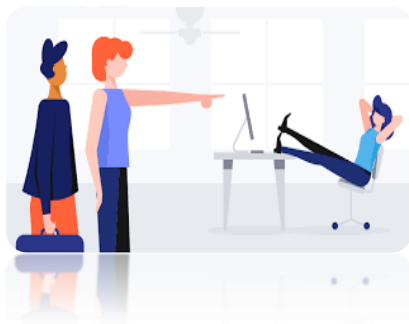
- i. Beneficence is defined as "**doing good**" for the benefit of others.
- ii. Beneficence is the effort to save lives and relieve human suffering (do good), only within reasonable limits.



4. Non-maleficence:

Non-maleficence means "**do no harm**", which encompassing;

-Negligence



-Malpractice



(1) Professional Negligence is defined as an individual ignores of basic responsibilities and that lack of action, which leads to hurt another individual or group. Thus when a professional (e.g., nurses, physicians, dentists, ...etc) is negligent of their clients this means hurt, which include all improper and wrongful conduct that fall below a professional standard of due care.

(2) **The term Malpractice** refers to a type of negligence, where a licensed professional fails to provide services as per standards set by the governing body.

Example

A doctor doesn't perform the duties in accordance with the medical standards, resulting in patient's harm.

- **Here** are the most common causes for *malpractice* claims against nurses:
 - **Failure to** communicate.
 - **Failure to** assess and monitor.
 - **Failure to** follow standards of care,
 - **Failure to** use equipment in a responsible manner.
 - **Failure to** delegate tasks properly.
 - **Failure to** act as patient advocate.
 - **Failure to** document.

6. Confidentiality:

- Confidentiality comes from Latin word "Fide" mean (Trust), which means keep information private.
- Confide as to “show trust by keeping secrets”.
- So, confidentiality refers to personal information that is protected as private information. Such information may not be released by healthcare providers when acquired in a professional capacity without taking consent from a patient.



When a patient's test is positive for HIV/AIDS and has no intention of telling his or her spouse about this diagnosis. In this instance, ***the physician is obligated to warn*** the spouse directly or indirectly of the risk or potential harm.

Example "This area of legislation concerned with health care privacy and disclosure reveals the tension between what is good for the individual vis-a-vis what is good for society".

Can Nurses Violate Confidentiality?

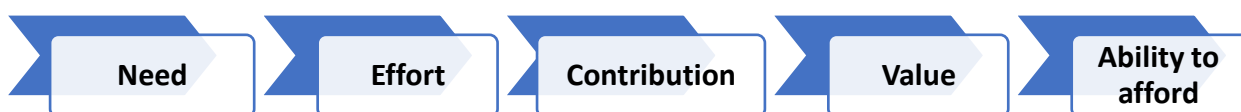
7. Justice = Seeks fairness.

- It refers to treating people fairly.
- It is the fair distribution of goods and services, benefits and costs among society's members.
- The law is the justice system. It focuses on the protection of society; the focus of health law is on the protection of the consumer.
- Nurses frequently face decisions in which a sense of justice should prevail (succeed). **E.g.** busy unit and new admission.



- People demand justice when they consider themselves unfairly treated or not receiving a fair hearing.
- If a person doesn't receive a fair trial, the principle of justice allows an appeal to review the case.
- It is unjust to treat a person better or worse than another person in a similar condition or circumstance, unless a difference in treatment can be justified with good reason.

- Decision making for the fair distribution of resources includes the following criteria.
- **Each group/community must have an equal share, which should be distributed according to:**



- Ensuring fair allocation of resources. (Example: appropriate staffing or mix of staff to all clients).
- Determining the order in which clients should be treated. (Example: priority treatments for the clients in pain).



8. Veracity: (*Telling the Truth*):

- The obligation to tell the truth and not to lie or deceive others, being honesty.
- Veracity is an important component of building trusting relationships.
- Veracity**, or **truth telling** is closely linked to informed decision making and informed consent.

9. Fidelity:

- It refers to keep promises.
 - “Fidelity means being faithful to one's commitments and promises”
 - Fidelity is not only keeping commitment, but also keeping or maintaining our obligation.

Example

- Nurses' commitments to clients, which include providing safe care and maintaining competence in nursing practice.
- Nurse must use good judgment when making promises to client



Chapter (3)



Values in Nursing And Professional Ethics

Values in Nursing and Professional Ethics

Learning Objectives:

After completion of this lecture the students' should be able to:

- Define values.
- Discuss types of values.
- List classification of value.
- Enumerate sources of value.
- Explain formation of value.
- Identify characteristics of values.
- Discuss important values in nursing profession.
- Identify methods of value transmissions.
- Explain essential Nursing Ethical Values and Behaviors.
- Identify the most common values in the nursing profession.
- Identify values statements, values Conflicts and resolution of values conflicts.

Content outlines:

- Definition of values.
- Types of values.
- Classification of value.
- Sources of value.
- Characteristics of values.
- The important values in nursing profession.
- Methods of value transmissions.
- Essential Nursing Ethical Values and Behaviors:
- The most common values in the nursing profession:
- Values statements, values Conflicts and resolution of values conflicts.

Introduction:

- ✓ **A value is** derived from a person's cultural, ethnic and religious background; from societal traditions, peer group and family.
- ✓ **Values** bring *direct and indirect moral meaning* to human existence.

Definitions of Values:

■ Values:

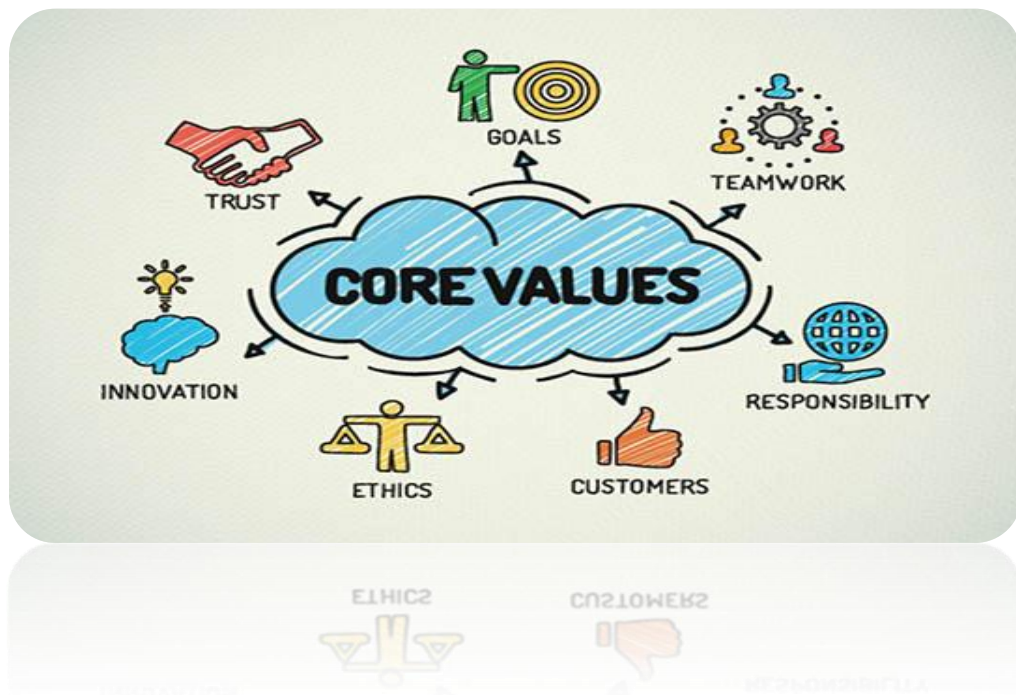
Values are concepts or ideas that give meaning to one's life.

■ Values:

Provide a framework for one's decisions and actions. They are the personal aspects and foundation of social ethical living.

Example

Individuals feel most comfortable with people who hold similar values.



Types of Values:

Personal values	Professional Values
People need personal values to have sense of individuality and to feel accepted. Personal values develop from: - Individual social traditions. - Cultural, ethnic religious norms. Examples: Self-worth, Sense of humor, Honesty, Fairness, Love, Responsibility.	They are acquired during socialization within the practice of nursing profession from: Code of ethics. Nursing experience. Teachers. Peers. - People need social values to feel accepted, and they need personal values to produce a sense of individuality. Professional values often reflect and expand on personal values.

As values are different from one to another as by principle;

“No one set of values is right for everyone”

N.B

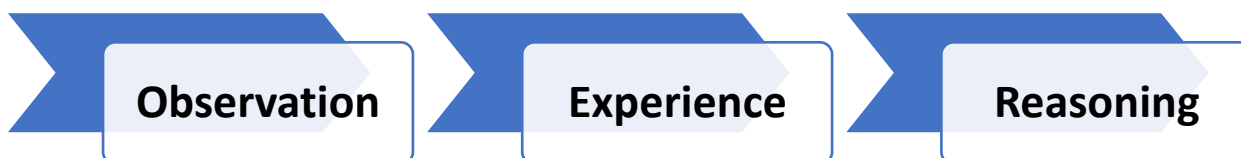
Therefore, nurses in their practice have to clarify their values, as well as patient's /client's values.



Sources of Value:

1. **Values are rooted since human exist;** the structure of human nature comes from both genetically & culturally.
2. **Values are so fundamental to human;** they rise above cultural boundaries.
3. **Values are socializing influences;** they come from community, peer culture, role models and experiences that challenge a way of thinking.

Formation of Value:



Characteristics of Values:

Values are:

1. Freely chosen.
2. They consist of beliefs or attitudes.
3. Learned through observation and experience.
4. Influenced by a person's socio-cultural environment, tradition, ethnic, religion, as well as by family and peer group.

Important Values in Nursing Profession:

1. Autonomy.
2. Commitment to education.
3. Strong commitment to service.
4. Belief in the dignity and worth of each person.

N.B

(1) Nurses should be nonjudgmental.

(2) Nurses should accept a client's values, beliefs rather than assume their own are the "right ones"

N.B

Remember: Never impose your personal values and never offer an opinion.

Methods of Value Transmissions:

- **Modeling:** Acting.
- **Reward and Punishment.**
- **Moralizing:** Standard of right and wrong.

Essential Nursing Ethical Values:

❖ **Altruism:**

✚ Nurses and health care provider have spirit for the welfare and helping the others.

❖ **Autonomy:**

✚ It is the right of self-determinant (right of independency).

❖ **Integrity:**

✚ It is the acting in accordance with code of ethics and standard of practice.

❖ **Social justice:**

✚ It is a fair distribution of resources and provision of client's equal treatment and nursing care.

❖ **Human Dignity:**

✚ Respecting patient's beliefs, **maintaining dignity and privacy during clinical procedures and communication.**

Example: Cover patients' body parts if exposed and keep patients' secrets confidential.

❖ **Precision and Accuracy in Caring:**

✚ Precise and accurate care has been indicated as a nursing ethical value, multi-dimensional and kind care given to the patients by nurses.

✚ Adequate clinical skills and nursing knowledge are needed to fulfill clients' needs, promote their health and relieve their pain and suffering.

❖ Responsibility:

- ✚ It is defined with traits of commitment, feeling responsible for the duties toward patients, and respecting the patients' rights for decision making.
- ✚ Nurses are responsible for giving evidence-based care, best clinical function, applicable and valid research and are accountable for their actions and duties.

❖ Human Relationship:

- ✚ It is indicated as a nursing ethical value with traits of mutual respect, trust, and reliance which are accompanied by patients' confidentiality and privacy.
- ✚ It can be verbal or non-verbal and defined through having honesty in words and practice, sympathy and mutual understanding, courtesy, and friendliness.

❖ Individual and Professional Competency:

- ✚ Individual and professional competency has been defined with traits of struggling to make nursing as a profession, feeling the need to acquire up-to-date knowledge and promotion of clinical skills and practical abilities.

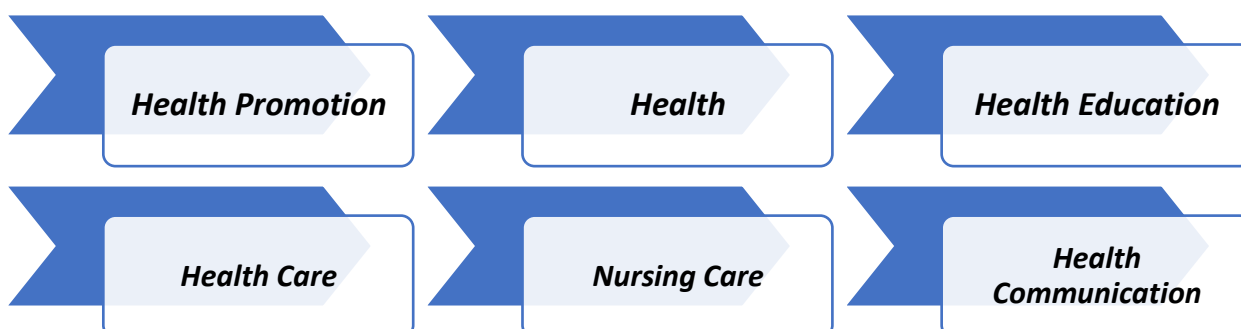
❖ Sympathy:

- ✚ Sympathy has been indicated as a nursing ethical value with traits of understanding patients' and their families' needs and giving care based on making a fair communication.
- ✚ In some cultures, such as Japanese, nurses share patients' physical and mental pains and sufferings.

❖ Trust:

- ✚ It is defined as traits of honesty in words and practice. Nurses should gain patients', their families', and society's trust through understanding patients' situation and status and appropriate conformation with them.

The most Common Values in the Nursing Profession



1. Value of Health:

- It is a state of complete mental, physical & social well-being & not merely the absence of disease or infirmity.

2. Value of Health Care:

- Health care is constantly changing.
- The patients are free to choose which treatment to have, where and when. Therefore, the patients should be well informed about available choices.
- The patients are in a position mentally and emotionally to make these choices.

3. Value of Health Promotion:

- Nursing goals is to help clients establish health – protection or health – promoting behaviors, by modifying unhealthy habits to achieve optimal levels of wellness.

4. Value of Nursing:

- The most urgent task for people is to find meaning for their lives, so that it is important to find the meaning of nursing. Values of nursing is changes according to changes of society' values

5. Value of Caring:

- It is the human mode of being and is a response to someone or something who or which matters.
- It is according to the human point of view, and characterized by human feelings and behaviors.

6. Value of Communication:

- Be attentive, intelligent, reasonable, responsible, and committed.

Values Statements:

Examples:

- Faith in God.
- Respecting others.
- Being respected by others.
- Being open and receptive to others.
- Experiencing true friendship.
- Loving parents.

Values Conflicts:

- Value conflict occurs when there is human interaction.
- Occurs when we must choose between two things, both of which are important to us.

Resolution of Values Conflicts:

- Be constructive (rather than destructive) in the methods you choose to work toward resolving the differences
- Listen carefully without interruptions
- Seek clarification using gentle questioning
- Respect cultural differences
- Be attentive to body language
- Explain the context of your point of view and try to picture the other person's expected of what you are saying
- Clarifying or explaining process that aim at defining the relevant issue, attitudes and beliefs.
- Answering questions.
- Coming to decision or a determination for future action, client may have several treatment options.



Chapter (4)



Code of Ethics for Nurses

Code of Ethics for Nurses”

Learning Objectives:-

By the end of this lecture, each student will be able to:-

- Define the code terms.
- Interpret code of ethics for nurses.
- List purposes of code of ethics.
- Enumerate the four kinds of the international codes of ethics.
- Discuss each one of the international codes of ethics.

Content Outline:

- Definition of the code terms.
- Interpretation for the code of ethics for nurses.
- Purposes of code of ethics.
- Types of the international codes of ethics.
- Explanation for each one of the international codes of ethics.

Introduction:

- The Code of Ethics establishes the ethical standard for the nursing profession.
- Codes of ethics are usually higher than legal standards and they can never be less than legal standards of the profession.

Code of Ethics Definitions:

- It is a systematic comprehensive collection of laws or rules.
- It is a formal statement of a group of ideals and values.
- It is set of ethical principles that:
 - Shared by members of a group.
 - Reflect their moral judgment over time.
 - Serve as standard for their professional action.

Nursing Code of Ethics is written by professional organizations.

Purposes of Code of Ethics are to:

- Inform the public about minimum standard of the profession.
- Help to understand professional nursing code of conduct.
- Provide ethical standard for professional behavior.
- Guide the profession in self –regulation.
- Remind nurses of the special responsibility they assume when caring for the sick.

There are Four Formal Nursing Codes of Ethics:

1- The International Council of Nurses (ICN) 1953

2- The American Nurses Association (ANA), which adopted the first code of ethics

1.4- The Australian Code of Ethics for Nurses (ACN).

5- The Canadian Code of Ethics for Nursing (CCN) adopted the first code of ethics in 1980.

1. International Council of Nurses (ICN) 1953:

The ICN 1953 established and published the first code of ethics for Nurses in which identified the four fundamental responsibilities of Nurse, which include:

- (1) Promoting health;
- (2) Prevent illnesses;
- (3) Restore health; and
- (4) Alleviate suffering.



International Council of Nurses
The global voice of nursing

II-The American Nurses Association (ANA):

It publishes the **most widely used and accepted Code of Ethics for Professional Nurses**. Its **nine** major principles that:

1. Patient dignity.
2. Commitment to a patient.
3. Optimum patient care.
4. Patient's rights.
5. Integrity and continued growth.
6. Advancement of nursing profession
7. Improved health care environment and employment.
8. Professional and public collaboration; and
9. Maintenance of values and integrity and shaping social policy.

ANA Code of Ethics Key Points:

- Primary commitment is to patient (individual, family or community)
- Demonstrates compassion and respect for all patients regardless of patient status.
- Promotes the health and welfare of patients.
- Accountable for individual practice.
- Maintains and increases own knowledge base.
- Works to improve healthcare environment for providers and patients.

III- The Australian Code of Ethics for Nurses (ACN):

It sets a **national standard** of conduct for nurses, and is closely related to the American version. It addresses ethical issues like:

- Dignity.
- Values.
- Honesty.
- Professionalism.
- Culture
- Beliefs

IV- The Canadian Code of Ethics for Nursing (CCN):

It defines ethical nursing care in Canada, which is also related to the American and Australian Codes of Ethical issues covered; also include:

- 1. Safety.**
- 2. Competence & Compassion; and**
- 3. Issues in different scenarios such as:**
 - Pandemics.
 - Relationships.
 - Conflicts or natural disasters.

Elements of the ICN Code of Ethics:

1. Nurses and people.
2. Nurses and practice.
3. Nurses and the profession.
4. Nurses and co-workers.
5. Nurse and Society.

1. Nurses and People: The nurse:

Her Primary professional responsibility is to:

Provide care; and Promotes an **environment** in which the

a. Human rights

b. Values.

c. Spiritual beliefs of the individual, family and community are **respected.**

- ***Ensures that the individual receives sufficient information*** on which to **base consent** for care and related treatment.

- ***Shares responsibility*** to sustain and protect the natural environment from depletion, pollution, degradation and destruction.

2. **Nurses and Practice:** The nurse should:

- Carry personal responsibility and accountability for nursing practice, and for maintaining competence by continual learning.
- Use judgment regarding individual competence when accepting and delegating responsibility.
- Maintain at all times the standards of personal conduct, which reflect well on the profession and enhance public confidence.
- Ensure when providing care that, use of technology and scientific advances are compatible with the safety, dignity and people's rights.

3. **Nurses and the Profession:** The nurse should:

- Determine and implements acceptable standards of clinical practice, management, research and education.
- Be active in developing a core of research-based professional knowledge.
- Participate in creating and maintaining equitable social and economic working conditions in nursing.

4. **Nurses and co-workers:** The nurse should:

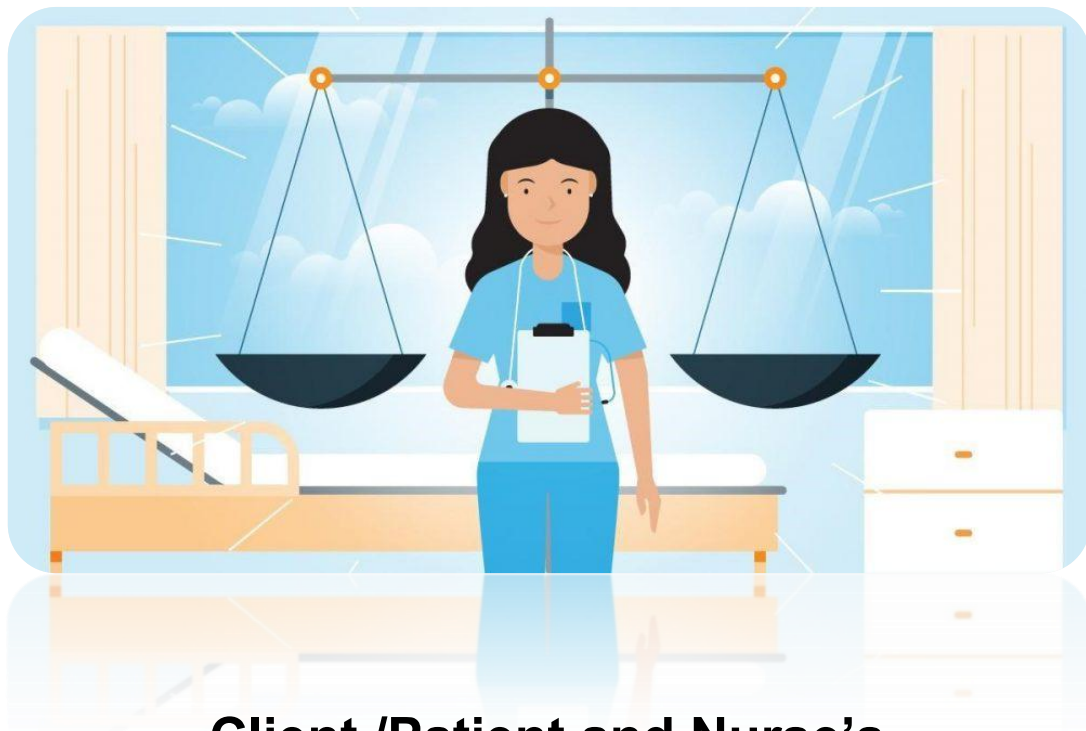
- Sustain a co-operative relationship with co-workers in nursing and other fields.
- Take appropriate action to protect individuals when their care is endangered by a co-worker or any other person.

5. **Nurse and Society:**

The nurse shares with other citizens the responsibility for initiating and supporting actions to meet the health and social needs of the public.



Chapter (5)



Client /Patient and Nurse's Rights & Responsibility

Client /Patient and Nurse's **Rights & Responsibility**

Learning objectives:

After completion of this lecture the students should be able to:

- Define related terms (Rights & Responsibility).
- Enumerate aspects of the responsibility.
- Discuss client/ patient's rights (Bill of Right).
- Describe client /Patient's responsibilities.
- Describe Nurse's rights & responsibilities.

Content Outlines:

- Definitions of related terms (Rights & Responsibility).
- Responsibility aspects.
- Client/ patient's rights (Bill of Right).
- Client /Patient's responsibilities.
- Nurse's rights & responsibilities

Introduction:

- In 1975, the American Hospital Association (AHA) disseminated a document entitled ***Patient's Rights***. A copy of these patient rights is f in a public place in ***every healthcare facility*** across the Unite
- Moreover, federal standards require that the ***patient should a personal copy*** of these rights, either at the time of hospital admission or prior to the initiation of care or treatment.
- Nowadays, we hear a lot about people's request and demands for their rights but much less about their responsibilities. Human rights go hand in hand with responsibilities. However, human rights promote human happiness and wellbeing because they protect people's vital needs and fundamental interests.

Definitions:

Rights:

- A right is a freedom that is protected, such as the right to free speech and religion.
- Compliant to justice.

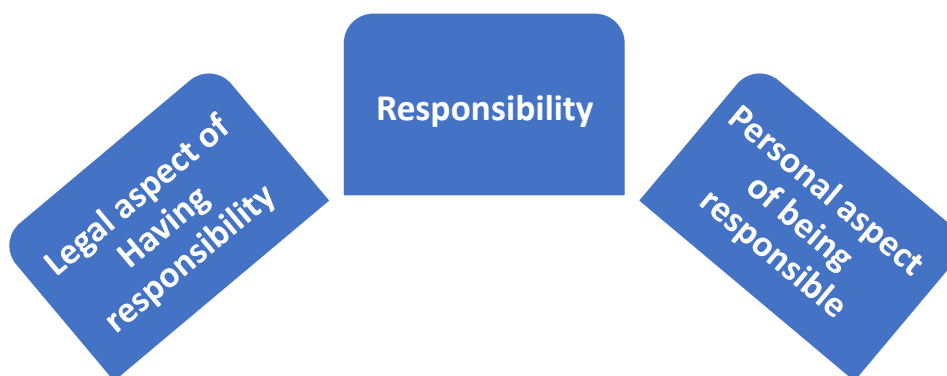
Examples:

- One person's rights are another's duty.
- A patient's rights are the nurse's duties.
- A nurse's rights are the employer's duties.
- A person's rights are based on human needs.



Responsibility:

- The duty or something you should do.
- An ethic of caring is based on a basic relationship
- It is the ability to respond in order to be able to care.



- Duty is generally linked to something prescribed or responsibility is linked to freedom to goodness and to rightness.



Having Legal responsibility: It means

- A job for which the person is paid.
- Answer to someone' request or something specific, usually is defined by contract.
- The contract helps to know what the limits of these actions are.

Example

The student nurse is not responsible to catheterize patient on her first placement

Being Responsible:

- A person who feels involved in other person's affairs (e.g. Care).
- It is an active participation or an interest in specific activities.
- It is a truly ethical act; aware of what is happening and be prepared to engage with it and work for its positive advance.

Clients/Patient Rights and Responsibilities



A. Patient has the Right to:

- Have respectful care to dignity, regardless of nationality, color, age, sex, religion, and disability.
- Obtain relevant current, understandable information concerning diagnosis, treatment, and any other instructions about the follow – up, besides the prognosis.
- Know the name of the physician, nurses, and staff members involved in the treatment.
- Be seen by the consultant within 24 hours from admission and on a regular basis after that during the episode of admission.
- Make decision about the plan of care prior and during the course of treatment.
- Have privacy in examination, treatment, and discussion.
- Confidentiality.
- Discuss openly and in full confidentiality about illness in a convenient atmosphere.

- Review records and information regard care.
- Appropriate care and services within the capacity of hospital.
- Be informed about business relationship between hospitals, educational institutions and payers especially if this has influence on his/her care and treatment
- Decline to participate in proposed research studies affecting care and to have these studies fully explained before involvement and prior to consent.
- Reasonable continuity of care and to be informed by physician.
- Be informed about the hospital policies and practices that related to patient care and treatment.
- Know the reason for any test or diagnostic procedures that will be done.
- Know the nature of risks of any procedure.
- Refuse signing the consent form for any test that he feels does not have information about.
- Change his mind and to refuse the test that has agreed upon.
- Limit those persons who would visit or call during admission, in accordance with hospital policy and procedure.
- Obtain any information or documents, such as medical reports, sick leave, etc.... as documented in the medical chart.
- Request consultation or second opinion from other physician's through the treating consultant guided by the hospital's administrative policy.
- Request for a change of physicians as per hospital policy.
- Change or transfer to other hospital as per policy.
- Right to receive care in a safe environment free from all forms of abuse, neglect, or mistreatment.

Patient Rights



A. Client/Patient's Responsibilities:

In the meantime, that patient has the right in different aspects related to his/her care, also patient has responsibilities that to be met to ensure the effectiveness of care and treatment and the satisfaction of patient with the course of treatment.

The following are things that patients are asked to do to help health care provider to keep their promises.

a) Be honest with health care professionals about:

- Patient's health status.
- Any changes the family has noticed about patient's feeling.
- Received medicines.
- Families' needs or worries.
- Any religious, culture, or learning needs.

b) Patient's help in receiving appropriate care by:

- Follow the direction of doctors, nurses and others who take care of patient.
- Keep appointments, being on time, and inform if in case of change appointment.
- Follow the treatment plan established by the physician, including the instructions of nurses and other health professionals as they carry out the doctor's order.

c) Follow health settings' rules and regulations by:

- Never bring a weapon into any of the health facilities.
- Not use foul or abusive language.
- Never hit or threat another patient, family member, or staff member.
- Make the organization smoke-free, alcohol-free, and free of illegal drugs.
- Use only the medications that doctor's prescribed.
- Be committed to the visiting hours.

- Keep the volume of personal TV, Radio, or tape player at a level that will not bother others.
- Use hospital supplies with care.

d) Respect other patients and families by:

- Giving them privacy.
- Limiting own visitors and having them observe visiting hours.
- Keep what heard about others to self

N.B.:

While patient health is health care provider's first concern, he/ she and their families are responsible for the hospital bill and need to:

- Find a way to pay the bill as soon as possible.
- Ask for help if there is a problem in paying the bill.
- Give the health care provider correct information about personal insurance.
- Give the health care provider any records or forms that the insurance company needs to pay the bill.



Nurse's Rights and Responsibilities

A. Nurses have the Right to:

- Maximize the contributions of nurses to society, it is necessary to protect the dignity and autonomy of nurses in the workplace.
- Practice in an environment that allow them to act in accordance with professional standards and legally authorized scopes of practice.
- Work in an environment that supports and facilitates ethical practice, in accordance with the code of ethics for nurses and its interpretive Statements.
- Work in a safe environment for themselves and their patients.
- Not to be abused in any form by physicians, pharmacists, administrators or nursing directors. Any abuse that occurs should be dealt with in a professional and in partial manner by the nurse's employer
- Not to be abused by being floated to areas of practice that they are not familiar with.
- Refuse any assignment that they feel unsafe. Such as when a nurse is assigned for a patient load and feels unsafe, as well as to work in an unfamiliar nursing area



B. Nurses' Responsibilities:

1. Nurse's Responsibilities Focus on:

- Providing information, about past illnesses, hospitalization, medication.
- Participate effectively in decision making.
- Informing their physician and other health care givers if anticipate problem in following prescribed treatment.
- Providing necessary information regard health insurance claim to make payment arrangement.

2. Nurse Responsibilities:

- Protect rights and safety of the patients.
- Ensure safe storage of the client's valuables.
- Ensure treatment and procedures are completed.
- Complete and distribute a nursing discharge summary.
- Provide education, counseling and group work services.
- Orient the client to the ward environment and daily routine.
- Maintain communication that facilitates nursing team work.
- Using the nursing process to deliver comprehensive care for patient.
- Provide direction and supervision to less experienced registered nurse.
- Participate in research and policy development within the
- Refuse to carry out orders that the nurse believes to be harmful to the clients.
- Ensure that patients are aware, understand and is involved in their treatment plan.
- Outline the relevant details of patient, summarize the decisions and document the nursing care plan as soon as possible after the word round.

- Alleviate the suffering experienced by individuals, families, groups and communities.
- Provide services that maintain respect for human dignity and accept the uniqueness of each patient and the nature of health problems, without restriction with regard to social and economic status practice setting



Chapter (6)



Ethical and Professional Conduct For Nursing Students

Ethical and Professional Conduct

For Nursing Students

Learning Objectives:

After completion of this lecture the nursing student should be able to:

- Identify the objectives of the designed guideline.
- Enumerate the three categories of the designed guideline.
- Discuss each category of the guideline
- Differentiate between the different three categories.
- Give examples for the three categories of the guidelines.

Content Outlines:

- The objectives of the designed guideline.
- The three categories of the designed guideline.
 1. Nursing student and the client;
 2. Nursing student and other health professionals; and
 3. Nursing student and the profession.
- Examples for the three categories of the guidelines

Introduction:

- Nursing is based on the ethical value of a commitment to promote well-being by providing competent and compassionate care.
- Nursing students when entering their educational program should be committed to:
 1. Learning and
 2. Accepting the ethical standards of conduct of the profession.
- During their educational program, nursing students strive to learn to:
 1. Promote; restore; and support health;
 2. Prevent illness; and
 3. Relieve suffering.

N.B.: *Furthermore, nursing students will reflect on their own values and learn about the profession's values.*

The importance of Ethical Guidelines and Professional Conduct for nursing students:

The guidelines help nursing student to:

1. Provide ethical nursing care;
2. Meet the Faculty's expectations regarding ethical & professional conduct;
3. Become reflective ethical practitioners; and
4. Motivate to think about & resolve ethical and professional questions besides issues.

N.B.:

- This guidelines and codes are beneficial because they state values, obligations and limitations.

- However, ***some ethical questions cannot be answered only by reference to a rule or guideline.*** Therefore, nursing students are encouraged to discuss ***ethical issues, concerns*** and ***questions*** as they arise, with their ***instructors and student group.***
- The Faculty of Nursing's Guidelines for Ethical and Professional Conduct for Nursing Students complement the University Code of Behavior; and the Appearance of Student in Uniform. Students are responsible for knowing these documents and complying with the code and guidelines.
- Nursing students are engaged in a number of relationships and therefore have obligations to different individuals and groups.

The guidelines are divided into three categories:

1. Nursing student and the client;
2. Nursing student and Other health professional;
3. Nursing student and the profession.

1) The Nursing Student and Clients:

The nursing student is expected to respect the needs and values of clients. The following guidelines will assist the student in meeting this expectation.

The nursing student should:

- a. Be respectful of client's rights, values, culture and religion, recognizing that the client is an autonomous person with individual needs and choices.
 1. ***Strive to establish a therapeutic and caring relationship*** with clients (This professional relationship is based on trust which must not be violated).
 2. ***Provide safe, competent care to client(s).***
 3. ***Communicate verbally and non-verbally*** with clients and families in a professional manner.

4. **Maintain client/family confidentiality.** The client or designated other must consent to information being disclosed to his/her family, friends, other individuals, and/or health professionals who are not members of the client's health care team.

- Keep client/families information confidential; it should not be discussed in public areas. Information can only be shared by the nursing student with the client's health care team.
- The general rule is that clients must consent to disclosure of information to any individuals who are not members of the client's health care team.
- However, ***under exceptional circumstances, information can be disclosed without the client's consent:***

Example

If the safety of the client or others is at serious risk unless specific information is disclosed. Under such circumstances, the nursing student should discuss the situation with his/her instructor. If the instructor is unavailable immediately, the nursing student should discuss the situation promptly with a responsible person in the clinical setting.

5. The nursing student should ***recognize that attendance at clinical placements is compulsory.***

6. ***Inform his/her instructor as soon as possible,*** or according to the manner established by the instructor, if he/she **is unable to attend the clinical placement due to illness** or extenuating circumstances.

7. **When a nursing student does not wish to provide care** to a client for ethical or religious reasons or because of a conflict in values, the student

should discuss the assignment with the instructor. Meanwhile, the nursing student must continue providing care until the issue is resolved (getting student opinions).

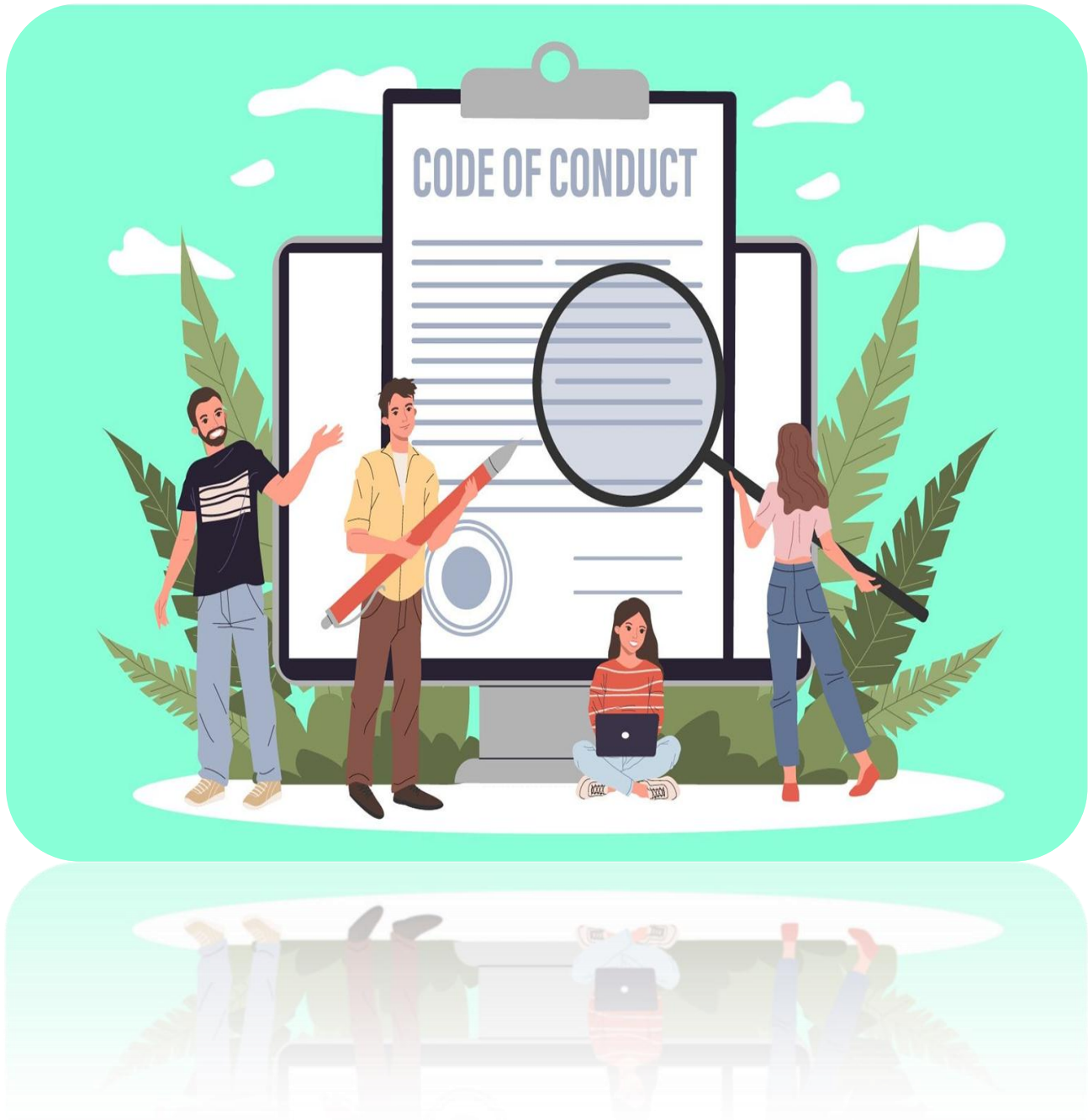
8. The nursing student must *not be under the influence of substances* (for instance, alcohol and illicit drugs) during class or at the clinical area.

- b. Advocacy: A responsibility of nursing students is to advocate for the rights of all clients. This requires the nursing student to understand the client's rights and responsibilities.
- c. The nurse advocates for an environment that provides sufficient physical privacy, including privacy for discussions of a personal nature. Nurses also participate in the maintenance of and policies and practices that protect both personal and clinical information at institutional and societal levels.
- d. Take appropriate action to ensure the safety of clients, self, and others.
- e. Provide care for the client in a timely, compassionate and professional manner.
- f. Communicate client care in a truthful (Veracity), timely and accurate manner.

2) The Nursing Student and Other Health Care Professionals:

The following guidelines will assist the nursing student to develop and maintain professional relationships and ethical conduct with colleagues.

- The nursing student is a member of the client's health team. Therefore, the nursing student should ***accept responsibility to work co-operatively*** with peers, the instructor and other health care professionals to ***provide competent and safe client care.***



(Ethical situation)

- **In the event** that a nursing student has reason to believe that another student or health care professional is not giving competent and safe care, and/or is giving care under the influence of drugs and/or alcohol, the students are to:
 - First obligations ***protect the client from harm;***
 - ***Ensure that client dignity is respected;*** and
 - ***Inform the instructor*** of the situation immediately.
- ☐ **If the instructor is not available immediately**, the nursing student should inform promptly a responsible person at the clinical setting of the **misconduct**.
- ☐ Both **misconduct and failure to report misconduct** can result in a client being harmed ***psychologically*** and ***physically***.
- ☐ It is left to the student's discretion whether he/she also wants to discuss the issue with the student(s) or health professional(s) involved.

3) The Nursing Student and the Profession:

The nursing student represents the nursing profession. Therefore, the student has an obligation to:

- (1) Know and appreciate the nursing profession's values; and
- (2) Incorporate them into his/her practice.

The Unique Roles of the Student Nurse:

- Enthusiasm and passion.
- Knowledgeable, observer and participant

- Fresh eyes unhindered by rituals and past practice
- Vested interest in future of the profession
- Opportunity to participate in shaping the future

Do

• **The nursing student must:**

- 1- Show interest in patient's saying.
- 2- Let your face show interested.
- Use good manners. Speak clearly, slowly, pleasant way.
- Use normal words.
- Respect pt's moods.
- Make your body movement look pleasing and energetic.

Do not

• **The nursing student must not do :**

- Let the pt. think you are too busy to listen.
- Refuse to do something you should do.
- Use slang "bad words.
- Use loud voice, unclear when speaking with patient.
- Use bad, sad gestures or unclear movements.
- Leaving patient unexcused during conversations.

References

1. Gawande A. (2020). Cowboys and Pit Crews Harvard Medical School Commencement Address.
2. Institute of Medicine [IOM]. (2020). The Future of Nursing: Leading Change, Advancing Health. Retrieved from [http://www.iom.edu/ Reports/2010/The-future-of-nursing-leading-change-advancing-health](http://www.iom.edu/Reports/2010/The-future-of-nursing-leading-change-advancing-health).
3. Mitchell P, Wynia M, Golden R, McNellis B, Okun S, Webb CE, et al. (2018). Core Principles and Values of Effective Team-Based Health Care Discussion Paper. Washington, DC: Institute of Medicine.
4. World Health Organization. (2020). Being an effective team player Retrieved from URL:http://www.who.int/patientsafety/education/curriculum/who_mc_topic-4.pdf.